

which are popular means of deciphering hashes. We look at salts, which offer some protection against such means of hacking hashes.

The third section in this Fast Track could actually be looked at as two sections, on “Hacking the network” and “Hacking the web”. It is as such divided into two parts. Hacking over the network, and hacking websites are some of the most common attacks. We look at what goes behind an attack and how one can be stopped.

In the “Network hacking” part we look at hacking network infrastructure and the steps that need to be taken before a successful attack can be made. We divide the process into four steps of “Footprinting”, which is the preliminary research conducted based on freely available information; “Scanning”, which involves poking and prodding network systems for information on vulnerable systems; “Enumeration / Banner Grabbing”, where we actually connect to systems which are attackable and gather relevant system data; “Penetration”, is the final step of exploiting vulnerabilities and constructing attacks based on the information gathered in the previous steps.

In the “Web Application Hacking” part we look at ten of the most common attacks that plague the internet today. The list of attacks is as featured by “OWASP Top 10 for 2010” and we use a framework called WebGoat for studying a few of these attacks.

Over the course of this section we will cover in detail: “Injection”, “Cross-Site Scripting”, “Broken Authentication and Session Management”, “Insecure Direct Object References”, “Cross Site Request Forgery (CSRF)”, “Security Misconfiguration”, “Insecure Cryptographic Storage”, “Failure to Restrict URL Access”, “Insufficient Transport Layer Protection”, and “Unvalidated Redirects and Forwards”.

In concluding, with “Hacking... Anything” we look at how the world of hacking is not limited to only computers. We look at the advantages of hacking and how a hackable application is not always a bad thing.

This Fast Track also includes a few appendices which contain some further information relevant to for those starting their hacking activities. 